

LEVEL DESIGN DOCUMENT

MALKUTH: THE KINGDOM

Sphere 10 — The Terrestrial Paradise | GDD v2.0 Aligned

Game:	Dark Angels (MALAKH: The Dark Ascension)
Level #:	10 (Entry Level / Tutorial-Disguised)
Sphere:	Malkuth — The Kingdom (■■■■■■■■■)
Color Palette:	Garden Green, Pale Gold, Pure White
Est. Duration:	18 minutes
GDD Version:	2.0 — Biblical-Kabbalistic Lore Revision
Date:	August 2026

"The Kingdom is the closest sphere to Man. It is beautiful, welcoming, and deceptively peaceful. " The birds do not sing — they repeat. The flowers do not move with the wind — they move in unison."

1. LEVEL HEADER

Malkuth (Hebrew: מַלְכוּת, 'Kingdom') is the tenth and final sphere of the Tree of Life in Kabbalah. It represents the physical world, the material realm, and the divine presence in creation. In Dark Angels, it is reimagined as a terrestrial paradise — an Eden of impossible beauty that serves as the outermost defensive perimeter of Heaven. This document is aligned with GDD v2.0.

1.1 One-Sentence Identity

A serene paradise of perfect geometry and classical celestial architecture that gradually reveals itself as a guarded fortress, teaching the player that even Eden has walls, and those walls have watchers who do not sleep.

1.2 The Two Questions

What is this place?	The realm closest to the material world. Perfect geometric gardens with hedges forming sacred symbols. Fountains where water flows upward. A pale gold sky that never darkens. Architecture blends classical Greek/Roman with Hebrew temples. It is the 'front door' of Heaven — beautiful, welcoming, and deceptively peaceful. But something is wrong: the birds do not sing, they repeat. The flowers do not move with the wind — they move in unison. Monuments of an angel with feet rooted in the earth mark the landscape.
Why is the player here?	Malakh has infiltrated the celestial realms by possessing a pure-evil soul that lived a righteous life. Malkuth is his entry point. To ascend to Yesod and beyond, he must overcome the terrestrial guardians — the Angel Messengers — and prove he belongs, or at least that he can fool the gatekeepers. He must maintain his Masquerade (Farsa) or risk being discovered as an intruder.

1.3 Definition of Done

- Player has mastered: movement (walk, run, jump, climb), basic melee attack, dodge roll, block/parry, and Stamina management.
- Player has encountered Angel Messengers: observed their patrol behavior, understood their non-hostile default state, and learned Farsa mechanics.
- Player has survived the Celestial Snare trap sequence and understands pattern-recognition hazards.
- Player has defeated Gabriel of the Gates using patience, mirror-navigation, and correct answers to celestial questions.
- Player understands the Farsa (Masquerade) Meter and has experienced at least one consequence of low Farsa (suspicion/alert).
- Player has used the Altar of Contemplation (checkpoint) and understands the risk/reward of offering Tears of Repentance.

- Player has experienced the tonal shift from paradise to hostility and feels the thematic tension of the celestial uncanny.

2. VISUAL DESIGN — GDD v2.0 ALIGNED

This section defines the visual identity of Malkuth as specified in the Game Design Document v2.0. All art, lighting, and environment design must adhere to these pillars.

2.1 Color Palette

Garden Green	#7CB342	Grass, hedges, moss on stone. The living geometry of the garden.
Pale Gold	#D4AF37	Sky gradient, light shafts, fountain water, trim on architecture.
Pure White	#FFFFFF	Angel robes, marble, clouds, sacred symbols. Purity made visible.
Cream Stone	#F5F5DC	Greek/Roman columns, temple walls, bridge stonework.
Deep Brown	#5D4037	Earth, tree bark, roots of the Angel Terrestrial statue.
Shadow Purple	#4A148C	Malakh's corruption particles, hidden passages, portal to Yesod.

2.2 Environment Architecture

- **Geometric Gardens:** Perfectly manicured hedges forming sacred symbols and Hebrew letters. The geometry is too perfect — no leaf out of place, no asymmetry. This creates the 'uncanny valley' of nature.
- **Upward-Flowing Fountains:** Water defies gravity, flowing from basin to basin in reverse. The sound is melodic but reversed — like a recording played backwards. Serves as navigational landmarks.
- **Classical Fusion:** Greek/Roman columns and pediments merged with Hebrew temple architecture. Torah scroll motifs carved into marble. The style says 'this is the origin of all human civilization, perfected.'
- **The Uncanny Flora:** Flowers move in perfect unison, not with the wind. Birds repeat the same three-note call in mechanical precision. No insect sounds. No decay. Everything is eternal and frozen in perfection.
- **Pale Gold Sky:** A sky of constant late-afternoon gold. No sun visible. No shadows shift over time. Time does not pass in Malkuth — it is always the same perfect moment.
- **The Angel Terrestrial Statue:** Repeated monument showing an angel with feet rooted in the earth, wings touching the sky. Made of brown stone with gold veins. Each statue faces the path forward, silently guiding the player.

2.3 Atmospheric Pillars

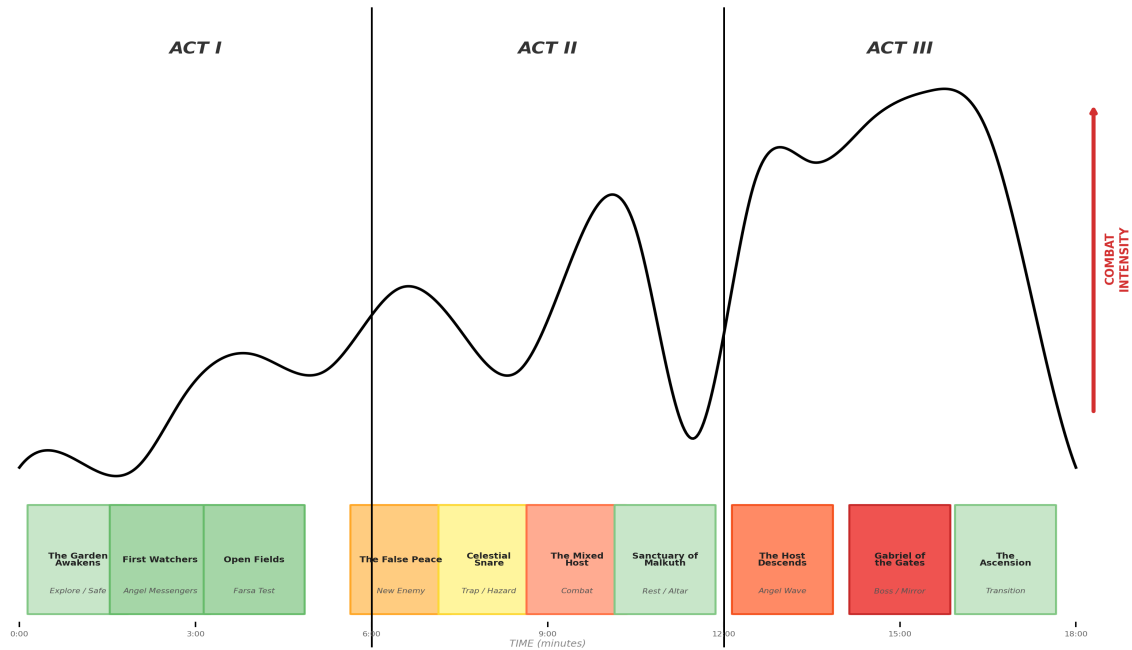
Serene but Wrong: The level must feel like a welcome mat that is also a trap. The beauty is overwhelming — and that overwhelm creates unease. Players should feel like they are trespassing in a place too perfect for them.

The Masquerade Mirror: Reflective surfaces (fountains, polished marble, mirrors in the boss arena) show Malakh's reflection. In Malkuth, his reflection looks like a normal human penitent — the Farsa is strong. As Farsa drops, the reflection flickers, showing shadow wings for a frame.

Soundscape: Gregorian chant ambient, but with reversed audio layers. No reverb — the sound is too clean, too dry for an outdoor space. This subtle wrongness signals to the player that Malkuth is not 'outside' — it is a room made to look like the world.

3. BEAT CHART & PACING CURVE

The following beat chart represents the 18-minute pacing curve for Malkuth. Intensity is measured on a 0–100 scale. The curve follows 'Teach → Test → Twist → Master' across three acts.



1	The Garden Awakens	Explore	0:00–2:00	5%	None
2	First Watchers	Combat / Teach	2:00–3:30	20%	2x Angel Messenger
3	Open Fields	Combat / Farsa	3:30–5:00	30%	3–4x Angel Messenger
4	The False Peace	New Enemy / Elite	5:00–7:00	50%	1x Archangel (Shield)
5	Celestial Snare	Trap / Hazard	7:00–8:30	25%	Light Ray Hazards
6	The Mixed Host	Combat	8:30–10:30	60%	3x Angel + 1x Archangel
7	Sanctuary of Malkuth	Rest / Altar	10:30–12:00	10%	None — Altar of Contemplation
8	The Host Descends	Survival / Wave	12:00–14:00	75%	6–8x Angel (waves)
9	Gabriel of the Gates	Boss / Mirror	14:00–16:30	95%	Gabriel — Mirror Labyrinth
10	The Ascension	Transition	16:30–18:00	5%	None — Portal to Yesod

4. ENCOUNTER DESIGN — TEACH / TEST / TWIST / MASTER

Each mechanic and enemy type introduced in Malkuth follows the Teach-Test-Twist-Master pattern. Teach: safe introduction. Test: apply under pressure. Twist: unexpected variation. Master: boss demands full integration. All encounters are aligned with GDD v2.0 enemy behaviors, Farsa system, and visual pillars.

4.1 THE GARDEN AWAKENS

Type:	Explore / Safe	Time:	0:00	Duration:	~2 min	Intensity:	5%
Enemies:	None						

Layout: Wide-open geometric garden. Perfectly manicured hedges form sacred Hebrew symbols. Upward-flowing fountains create melodic reversed-water sounds. Pale gold sky, no sun. Classical Greco-Roman columns mixed with Hebrew temple motifs. The Estatua del Ángel Terrestrial stands at the far end. Flowers move in unison. Birds repeat the same three-note call mechanically.

TEACH	Player learns movement: walk, run, jump, camera control. The space is too beautiful to feel like a tutorial. Flowers part as Malakh walks. Light shafts through hedges guide the eye forward. No enemies. No hazards.
TEST	Player must jump across a narrow stream (water flows upward into the next basin) and climb a small ledge. These are the only 'challenges' and they are impossible to fail. Introduces the uncanny: birds that repeat, flowers that sync.
TWIST	N/A — Pure Teach beat. The twist comes later when the player realizes this mechanical perfection is a prison disguised as paradise.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: First Corruptio Shard (hidden behind upward-fountain, teaches exploration). Lore tablet: Hebrew inscription about Malkuth. First view of the Angel Terrestrial statue.

Audio/VFX: Gregorian chant ambient with reversed audio layers. Mechanical bird calls (three-note repeat). Windless silence. Warm pale-gold color grading. No reverb — sound is too dry for outdoors.

4.2 FIRST WATCHERS

Type:	Combat / Teach	Time:	2:00	Duration:	~1.5 min	Intensity:	20%
Enemies:	2x Angel Messenger						

Layout: Narrow path between geometric hedges. Limited cover: two classical stone benches and a fallen column. No flanking routes. The path funnels both player and angels into a frontal confrontation. Thorn-barrier prevents retreat.

TEACH	Angel Messengers introduced: humanoid perfection, 1.8m, white robes, NO FACE (only light), single pair of wings. They carry trumpets and sceptres. They are NOT hostile initially — they observe Malakh, heads tilting in unison. Player learns: if Farsa is high (>70%), angels ignore him. If he attacks first or breaks a sacred symbol (hedge), they engage. First combat teaches: Light Attack combo (3 hits), dodge roll, block. Angels dissolve into feathers and light upon death.
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TEST	Both angels attack simultaneously if provoked. Player must manage two targets in restricted space. If player tries to run back, thorn-barrier prevents retreat — forces confrontation. Angels use trumpet stun ability once.
TWIST	N/A for this beat. The 'Twist' of Angel Messengers comes in Open Fields where they use patrol coordination and call for reinforcements.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: Small Corruptio boost. First health pickup (Tear of Repentance / Golden Apple). Lore: angelic seal dropped — 'Watchers of the Gate'. Farsa penalty: -5% for killing angels brutally (execution).

Audio/VFX: Music shifts: single dissonant choir note when angels detect hostility. SFX: angelic voices layered (non-human). VFX: angels dissolve into white feathers and light. Their face-light flickers before death.

4.3 OPEN FIELDS

Type:	Combat / Farsa Test	Time:	3:30	Duration:	~1.5 min	Intensity:	30%
Enemies:	3–4x Angel Messenger						

Layout: Large circular clearing surrounded by geometric hedges. Multiple broken columns for cover. Tall grass (moves in unison). Three elevation levels: low ground (center), mid ridges (east/west), small hill with broken obelisk (north). Angels patrol from three directions. A sacred symbol is etched in the center — stepping on it reduces Farsa by 10%.

TEACH	Angels now patrol in coordinated patterns. They use hand-signals (light flashes) to communicate. Player learns the Farsa system: if he crouches and moves slowly through tall grass, angels do not detect him (stealth). If he attacks, they coordinate. One takes high ground (obelisk) while two push from east. Player learns target prioritization.
TEST	Player must choose: stealth past (high Farsa reward, +1% per enemy evaded) or engage (combat practice). If player takes too long, a 4th angel spawns from the west — a 'messenger' who was patrolling nearby, called by the light signals.
TWIST	The 4th angel is a surprise spawn from behind the player's entry point. Additionally, if Farsa drops below 40% during this encounter, ALL angels become instantly hostile regardless of stealth — the first 'Alert' state experience. The player feels surrounded in paradise.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: Corruptio Shard (center, on the sacred symbol — risky to grab). Health pickup behind the obelisk. Lore: broken sword in a stone — hints at a celestial war. Farsa lesson: stealth is viable but slow; combat is fast but costly.

Audio/VFX: Music: low-intensity combat drones with Gregorian fragments. Intensity increases with each angel defeated. Environmental SFX: no wind, but grass moves in unison creating a soft rustle that masks footsteps.

4.4 THE FALSE PEACE

Type:	New Enemy / Elite	Time:	5:00	Duration:	~2 min	Intensity:	50%
Enemies:	1x Archangel						

Layout: Ruined celestial gazebo at the edge of a reflecting pool. Four pillars, broken dome. Marble floor polished to mirror sheen. The Archangel stands center, back to player, three pairs of wings folded. 2.5m tall. Armor of solid light. Space is medium-sized.

TEACH	Archangel introduced with scripted sequence: turns slowly, six wings unfold (casting massive shadow), draws sword of white fire. First phase: slow, telegraphed heavy swings. Player learns to dodge (block staggers Malakh). UI prompt: 'Hold [Ability] for Dark Strike.' Teaches Dark Ability input and the Posture system — charged attacks break posture.
TEST	Archangel raises Light Shield after losing 40% HP. Normal attacks bounce off. Player must use Dark Strike (Umbral Lunge) to break it. Shield recharges once, forcing repetition under pressure. If Farsa is high, the Archangel hesitates 1 second before attacking — subtle advantage.
TWIST	At 20% HP, Archangel calls 'Judgment Beam' from sky — vertical pillar of light tracking player for 3 seconds. This is the first environmental+enemy combined attack. Player must manage beam AND shield. Additionally, the polished floor reflects the beam, creating secondary danger zones — the environment turns hostile.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: First Dark Ability unlock: 'Umbral Lunge' (dash-through attack, breaks light shields). Costs 30% Corruptio. Health x2. Lore: Archangel's helm drops — faceless being of light. Inscription: 'Dominion begins at the threshold.' Farsa: -10% for killing an Archangel.

Audio/VFX: Music: full choral combat theme. Archangel's voice is deep Gregorian bass (non-human, reverb-heavy). VFX: shield shatters like stained glass. Judgment Beam scorches marble. Reflections on floor show Malakh as shadow-winged for 1 frame.

4.5 CELESTIAL SNARE

Type:	Trap / Hazard	Time:	7:00	Duration:	~1.5 min	Intensity:	25%
Enemies:	Environmental Hazard						

Layout: Long stone bridge crossing the reflecting pool. No cover. Sky is 'wrong' — too still, too perfect. At far end, the Sanctuary of Malkuth is visible. Bridge is lined with upward-flowing fountains that periodically stop, revealing safe zones.

TEACH	First ray of light strikes bridge ahead of player, leaving glowing scar. Second ray hits left 2 seconds later. Player learns pattern: rays preceded by charge-up sound (rising choir note) and brightening spot on ground. First section: single rays, spaced 3 seconds apart, obvious safe zones between fountains.
TEST	Mid-bridge: rays overlap. Two strike simultaneously from different angles. Player must read both ground-charge indicators. Wrong step = 25% damage + 'Blind' screen effect (1 sec). Farsa does not affect traps — they are automated celestial defenses.

TWIST	Final third: rays strike rapidly (every 1.2s) in 'cross' and 'checkerboard' patterns. The TWIST: pattern follows musical rhythm of Gregorian chant. Audio becomes gameplay cue. Additionally, upward-fountains stop flowing during final 10 seconds — safe zones disappear. Player must sprint the final stretch.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: Corruptio Shard at exact center of bridge (risk/reward). Health pickup just before end. Lore: drowned crown at bottom of pool (visible if player looks down) — foreshadows Keter.

Audio/VFX: Music: chant becomes rhythmic and percussive. Each ray strike timed to drum-like bass note. SFX: charge-up = rising choir note; impact = thunderclap + bell toll. VFX: ground glows gold → white → strike.

4.6 THE MIXED HOST

Type:	Combat / Combined	Time:	8:30	Duration:	~2 min	Intensity:	60%
Enemies:	3x Angel Messenger + 1x Archangel						

Layout: Courtyard before Sanctuary. Open space with central upward-fountain, four archways (N/S/E/W), low walls. Fountain provides partial cover. Two archways blocked by rubble; other two are spawn points. Flat elevation. A sacred mosaic on the floor — walking on it reduces Farsa by 5%.

TEACH	Angels spawn first (3) from east and west archways. Player must manage two fronts. After 15 seconds, Archangel descends from sky (scripted landing), crushing the fountain. Player learns mixed encounter prioritization: angels are fragile but numerous; Archangel is slow but devastating.
TEST	Archangel spawns with active Light Shield. Player must decide: eliminate angels first (safer, but Archangel gets free attacks) or focus Archangel (risky, angels flank during shield-break). Corruptio management matters — Umbral Lunge on shield is efficient but costly.
TWIST	At 50% Archangel HP, remaining angels enter 'Desperation': they self-destruct on death, creating light-blast zones. Player can no longer ignore them. Additionally, destroyed fountain floods center with ankle-deep water, slowing movement. If Farsa < 20% at this point, a 5th angel spawns as 'Inspector' — a special patrol angel who hunts Malakh specifically.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: Major Corruptio cache (under broken fountain, post-combat). Health x2. First Dark Relic fragment. Lore: celestial banner torn in half — 'The Kingdom shall not fall.' Farsa penalty: -15% total for this encounter.

Audio/VFX: Music: full orchestral+choir combat. Archangel landing silences music for 1.5 seconds (impact moment), then resumes louder. SFX: angel desperation cries are higher-pitched. Water splashing underfoot adds rhythmic texture.

4.7 SANCTUARY OF MALKUTH

Type:	Rest / Altar / Lore	Time:	10:30	Duration:	~1.5 min	Intensity:	10%
Enemies:	None						

Layout: Natural cathedral: massive trees whose branches intertwine into a vaulted ceiling. Shafts of pale gold light pierce through. Central dais with the Angel Terrestrial statue. Altar of Contemplation before the statue. Four paths lead out; three blocked by celestial energy. North path open — toward boss arena. Safe zone.

TEACH	Player is safe. No enemies. Music is pure Gregorian chant, uninterrupted. Player can interact with statue for a vision: flash of the Tree of Life, spheres glowing, and a voice: 'You do not belong here, yet here you are.' Teaches that lore is embedded in the world. Player learns to use the Altar: rest (recover HP + refill Tears of Repentance) OR offer a Tear for +20% damage buff (3 min) at the cost of one healing charge.
TEST	N/A — Pure rest beat. The 'test' is whether the player rushes ahead or absorbs the atmosphere. A hidden collectible behind the statue rewards thorough exploration. If player rests too many times, Farsa drops by 3% per extra rest.
TWIST	N/A
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: Full health and Corruptio regeneration. Tree of Life map overlay unlocked (showing Malkuth → Yesod). Lore: 'The Book of the Kingdom' — scroll detailing Malkuth as the 'vessel' that holds the divine in the material. First chance to view Malakh's wing corruption status (still mostly white, black tips barely visible).

Audio/VFX: Music: 'Ave Maria' style solo voice, then full choir. SFX: wind through tree-cathedral creates pipe-organ effect. VFX: light particles drift like pollen. Statue's eyes briefly follow Malakh if he stands still for 10 seconds.

4.8 THE HOST DESCENDS

Type:	Survival / Wave	Time:	12:00	Duration:	~2 min	Intensity:	75%
Enemies:	6–8x Angel Messenger (waves)						

Layout: Vast amphitheater of natural stone at base of a mountain. Tiered seating (empty) rises on three sides. Circular stage of polished marble. No cover on stage. Sky darkens progressively. Tiers too steep to climb — player is trapped.

TEACH	Wave 1 (0:00–0:40): 2 Angels descend from sky (scripted landings). Standard behavior. Wave 2 (0:40–1:20): 3 Angels, one with light spear (increased range). Wave 3 (1:20–2:00): 3 Angels spawn simultaneously from three compass points. Player learns wave management: don't get surrounded, use arena edges.
TEST	Waves are relentless — no pause between Wave 2 and 3. Player must manage Stamina and Corruptio across full 2 minutes. If player is too defensive, angels gain 'Zeal' buff (glow brighter, attack faster) after 30 seconds of inactivity. Forces proactive play.

TWIST	At 1:45, sky opens and a beam of light (not damaging) scans the arena. All surviving angels become invulnerable for 5 seconds and charge simultaneously. Player must survive via pure evasion — block and counter disabled by the light. The TWIST: the environment empowers enemies unpredictably. If Farsa < 30%, the beam also drains 10% HP over the 5 seconds.
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: Large Corruptio cache (center of stage, post-combat). Health x3 (scattered at arena edges, risky).
Lore: broken celestial horn — 'The trumpet that shall not sound until the end.'

Audio/VFX: Music: relentless rhythmic chanting accelerating with each wave. SFX: war-cries layered into choir of hundreds. Sky-darkening accompanied by low infrasound drone. VFX: angels descend as streaks of light. Marble cracks under impacts.

4.9 GABRIEL OF THE GATES

Type:	Boss / Mirror Labyrinth	Time:	14:00	Duration:	~2.5 min	Intensity:	95%
Enemies:	1x Archangel Gabriel						

Layout: The Throne of Malkuth: raised platform at mountain's peak. Circular arena, 40m diameter. Four pillars at cardinal points. Swirling vortex sky of brown and gold. But the arena is NOT a combat space — it is a labyrinth of mirrors. Polished marble walls, reflecting pools, suspended glass panels create infinite reflections. Gabriel sits on a throne of roots and stone. Upon approach, the throne crumbles. Gabriel stands. The mirrors activate.

TEACH	Phase 1 — The Labyrinth (100%–70%): Gabriel does not attack directly. He speaks. The labyrinth shifts with each sentence. Player must navigate the mirror maze while Gabriel asks questions: 'What brings you to the Kingdom?' 'Do you seek redemption?' Player chooses answers via dialogue wheel. Correct answers (humble, penitent) keep Farsa stable. Wrong answers (arrogant, defiant) activate traps: mirrors shoot light beams, floors become slippery, walls close in. Player learns: this is a test of patience, not strength.
TEST	Phase 2 — The Doubt (70%–40%): Gabriel's voice changes. He begins to SUSPECT. 'Your shadow is too long. Your steps are too quiet.' The labyrinth becomes smaller. Mirrors now show Malakh's TRUE reflection (shadow wings flickering). Player must avoid looking at mirrors for too long or Farsa drops rapidly (-5% per second of mirror-gaze). Traps become more frequent. Gabriel summons a single Angel Messenger as distraction.
TWIST	Phase 3 — The Judgment (40%–0%): The TWIST. Gabriel reveals he ALWAYS knew. 'The Gates do not open for the penitent. They open for the patient. But you, Malakh... you are neither.' The labyrinth SHATTERS. All mirrors break. The arena becomes open combat. Gabriel fights as a full Archangel: six wings, sword of white fire, Judgment Beams, Light Shield. But he is weakened by the shattered mirrors — his reflection is broken, and he takes 50% more damage from attacks aimed at his shadow (which appears on the cracked floor). This is the ultimate integration: patience (labyrinth) + combat (broken arena) + Farsa management (mirror-gaze) + environmental awareness (shadow attacks).
MASTER	The entire encounter is the MASTER beat. Every mechanic from the level is tested: movement (labyrinth), Farsa (answers + mirror-gaze), combat (shield-breaking, dodge, Dark Strike), trap-reading (light beams), and spatial awareness (shadow-weakness on cracked floor). Victory requires mastery of ALL systems, not just memorization.

Rewards: Boss Soul (major Corruptio infusion). Unlock: 'Wings of Malkuth' (glide ability for Yesod). Health x3.
Lore: 'The Crown of the Kingdom' — vision of Malakh on the throne. Player choice: reject (Farsa +10%) or accept

(Corruptio +50%, Farsa -20%). Gabriel's final words: 'The Foundation awaits... and it is not as merciful as I.'

Audio/VFX: Music: three-movement boss suite. Phase 1: slow, questioning chant (solo voice). Phase 2: accelerating dissonance, multiple voices arguing. Phase 3: full choir+orchestra, Latin lyrics about judgment and mercy. Gabriel's voice is three voices (bass, tenor, soprano) in unison. VFX: upon 'defeat,' Gabriel does not die — he kneels, crystallizes into salt/dust from the feet up, and crumbles. The vortex sky clears, revealing purple light — Yesod.

4.10 THE ASCENSION

Type:	Transition / Cinematic	Time:	16:30	Duration:	~1.5 min	Intensity:	5%
Enemies:	None						

Layout: A long stairway of light ascending from the Throne of Malkuth into a portal of swirling purple energy (Yesod). Stairs are translucent — below, the entire level is visible: meadow, pool, bridge, sanctuary, amphitheater. Player walks upward. No enemies.

TEACH	Player learns that ascent is the reward. Camera pans to show journey taken. Voice from Sanctuary returns: 'The Kingdom is behind you. The Foundation awaits.' Teaches narrative rhythm: each level ends with reflection before next challenge. Malakh's wings are now visibly tipped with black — corruption begins.
TEST	N/A
TWIST	N/A
MASTER	N/A

Rewards: N/A — Pure narrative reward. Unlock: Level Select (Malkuth replayable). Concept art: 'The Angel of Malkuth.' First view of Yesod's purple glow — the color of Foundation.

Audio/VFX: Music: single sustained choir note resolving to major chord as player enters portal. SFX: wind, distant bells, root-growth sounds (foreshadowing Yesod). VFX: portal's purple light reflects on Malakh's face. He does not smile. He simply walks forward. His shadow has wings.

5. ENEMY ROSTER — MALKUTH (GDD v2.0)

Only the Third Hierarchy (Servants and Messengers) appears in Malkuth. Each enemy follows the Teach-Test-Twist pattern. Enemy designs are strictly based on biblical descriptions as defined in GDD v2.0.

Angel Messenger	Grunt / Observer	Low	Medium	Humanoid perfection, 1.8m, white robes, NO FACE (only light). Beat 2 (First Watchers). Carries trumpet.	Beat 2 (First Watchers)
Archangel	Elite / Guardian	Medium-High	Slow	Humanoid perfection, 2.5m. THREE pairs of wings. Armored. Beat 4 (The False Peace). Hosts white fire. Hosts.	Beat 4 (The False Peace)
Gabriel of the Gates	Boss	Very High	Variable	Archangel guardian of Malkuth. Six wings. Does not fight. Beat 9 (Gabriel) — the Gates.	Beat 9 (Gabriel) — the Gates

5.1 Angel Messenger — Teach-Test-Twist Breakdown

TEACH	Beat 2 (First Watchers): Two angels in restricted path. Frontal attacks only. No flanking. Player learns basic combat and Farsa: they do not attack unless provoked.
TEST	Beat 3 (Open Fields): Multiple angels with flanking, high-ground usage, light-signal coordination, and reinforcement spawn. Player must manage space, priority, and Farsa (stealth vs combat).
TWIST	Beat 6 (Mixed Host): Angels gain Desperation (self-destruct on death). Beat 8 (Host Descends): Angels become invulnerable during sky-beam scan, forcing pure evasion. If Farsa < 20%, an 'Inspector' angel spawns.
MASTER	Beat 9 (Gabriel): Angels spawn as adds during the mirror-labyrinth boss fight. Player must navigate traps, answer questions, AND manage angel adds under extreme pressure.

5.2 Archangel — Teach-Test-Twist Breakdown

TEACH	Beat 4 (The False Peace): Solo fight with telegraphed attacks. Introduces Light Shield, Dark Strike requirement, and Posture Break. Safe space to learn elite patterns.
TEST	Beat 6 (Mixed Host): Archangel + 3 Angels simultaneously. Player must choose between eliminating adds or focusing the shielded elite. Environmental hazard (flooding) added.
TWIST	N/A in Malkuth — the Archangel's Twist is reserved for Yesod, where he gains flight and aerial bombardment.
MASTER	Beat 9 (Gabriel): While Gabriel is a unique boss, the Archangel fight in Beat 4 is the foundation for understanding shield-breaking, Judgment Beams, and heavy-attack timing.

6. MECHANICS INTRODUCED IN MALKUTH

Malkuth is the tutorial level disguised as paradise. It introduces all core systems that will be used throughout the 10 spheres. Each mechanic is taught through gameplay, not UI tutorials. The table below maps each mechanic to its teaching beat and GDD reference.

Stamina System	All actions consume Stamina. Management is the core of combat.	Beat 2	6.1.A
Posture Break	Parries and charged attacks break posture, opening execution windows.	Beat 4	6.1.A
Light / Heavy / Charged	Light: fast, low stamina. Heavy: slow, breaks guards. Charged: massive posture damage.	Beat 2	6.1.A
Dodge Roll / Aerial Dodge	I-frames on ground and air. Aerial dodge leaves feather-trail VFX.	Beat 2	6.1.A / 6.1.B
Block / Parry	Block reduces damage but drains stamina. Perfect parry breaks posture (Beat 4).	Beat 2	6.1.A
Farsa (Masquerade)	0-100% celestial trust meter. High = angels ignore you. Low = all enemies attack, bosses gain phases.	Beat 5	6.1.A
Dark Abilities	Umbral Lunge (dash-through) breaks light shields. Costs 30% Corruptio. Beaten 8s.	Beat 4	6.1.A
Corruptio Meter	Resource from defeating enemies and finding shards. Used for Dark Abilities.	Beat 1	6.1.A
Wings (False Prophet)	Planar (glide), Aerial Dodge, Diving Strike. Wings start white, corruptio turns them red.	Beat 9 (neward)	6.1.B
Tears of Repentance	3 healing charges. Restored at Altars. Risk: offer one for +20% damage taken (3 min).	Beat 7	6.1.C
Death / Mancha de Sombra	Leave a Shadow Stain on death. Recover it to regain Essences. Each death reduces max Farsa by 10% (min 50%).	Beat 6	6.1.A
Altar of Contemplation	Checkpoint. Restores HP and Tears. Respawns enemies. Extra rests reduce Farsa by 3%.	Beat 7	6.1.C / 6.2

6.1 Mechanics Pacing Philosophy

Mechanics are introduced one at a time, never simultaneously. Beat 1 teaches movement in a safe space. Beat 2 adds combat with forgiving enemies. Beat 3 adds Farsa/stealth. Beat 4 adds the elite enemy and Dark Strike. Beat 5 isolates pattern-recognition (traps) without combat pressure. Beat 6 combines everything learned so far. Beat 7 is a rest to process. Beat 8 tests endurance. Beat 9 demands mastery of all systems. Beat 10 is emotional closure. This staircase approach ensures no player is overwhelmed, but every player is prepared for what comes next.

7. PUZZLE & TRAP DESIGN

Malkuth is not only a combat tutorial — it is an introduction to the idea that Heaven itself is a system of rules, symbols, and sacred geometry. Puzzles and traps in this level are not arbitrary obstacles; they are manifestations of divine order. The angels do not need traps — the realm itself enforces obedience. Every puzzle connects to the core themes of the game: Farsa (the Masquerade), sacred geometry, and the tension between free will and divine law. Below, each puzzle/trampa is catalogued with its own Teach-Test-Twist, its Farsa interaction, and its narrative justification.

7.1 THE GEOMETRIC PATH

Beat:	Beat 1: The Garden Awakens	Type:	Ambient Navigation Puzzle	/ Farsa:	Neutral — no Farsa change
Justification:	Malkuth is the Kingdom — the sphere of divine order manifested in the material world. The garden is not decorative; it is a MANDALA. The hedges form the Tree of Life itself. To enter the Kingdom, one must walk the path of the Kingdom. This teaches the player that EVERYTHING in Heaven has meaning. Nothing is random. The puzzle exists because Malkuth IS sacred geometry made physical.				

Layout: The garden is a 100x100m square. Three main hedge-rows (center = Tree of Life, left = abstract thorns, right = abstract waves). Each Sephira in the center row is a 3m-diameter circular hedge cluster with a small fountain at its center (water flows upward). The path between clusters is 2m wide, paved with white marble. The Angel Terrestrial statue stands at the north end, between Keter and Malkuth clusters.

TEACH	Player enters the garden and sees three parallel hedge-rows. The center row forms the 10 Sephiroth as circular hedge-clusters connected by straight hedge-lines. The side rows form meaningless squiggles. Walking through the center path causes flowers to bloom and fountains to activate. Walking through the side paths causes hedges to grow taller (blocking the way) and birds to fall silent. The player learns: in Heaven, form has function.
TEST	Mid-garden, the path splits into three: left (Geburah/Severity), center (Tiphareth/Beauty), right (Chesed/Mercy). The 'correct' path is center (Tiphareth), but all three lead forward. However, the left path has a hidden Corruptio Shard (temptation of Severity), and the right path has a lore tablet (gift of Mercy). The center path is fastest but has no reward. The player learns that choices in Heaven have consequences.
TWIST	If the player tries to walk OFF the paths entirely (through the grass), the grass becomes thorns after 3 seconds, dealing 5% damage and pushing the player back. This is the TWIST: the 'freedom' of the open garden is an illusion. The Kingdom only allows movement along its ordained lines. It foreshadows the entire game's tension: Malakh thinks he is free, but Heaven is a system of rules he must learn to exploit.
MASTER	N/A — This is the foundational puzzle. Its 'mastery' is realized in Beat 9 (Gabriel), where the player must navigate a labyrinth that actively reshapes itself.

Audio/VFX: SFX: When player walks the correct path, a single chime per step (like a bell in a distant cathedral). When walking the wrong path, the chime is flat/dissonant. VFX: Correct path — flowers bloom in sequence (white → gold). Wrong path — hedges grow thorns (red emissive tips).

7.2 SACRED GROUND SYMBOLS

Beat:	Beat 3: Open Fields	Type:	Environmental Hazard Puzzle	Farsa:	Direct interaction — stepping on symbol reduces Farsa by 10%
Justification:	In Kabbalah, Malkuth is the sphere where the divine touches the material. The ground itself is sanctified. The sacred mosaic in the Open Fields is not a decoration — it is a SEAL. It marks the territory as belonging to the Kingdom. For Malakh, a demon wearing a stolen soul, stepping on sacred ground is like stepping on consecrated earth: it burns his disguise. This puzzle exists because Malkuth is not just a place — it is a CLAIM. The ground itself judges the unworthy.				

Layout: Circular clearing, 40m diameter. Center: 5m sacred mosaic (white marble, gold inlay). Around it: 12 smaller symbol stones (1m diameter each) forming a ring. The ring stones are flush with the ground — easy to miss while running. Broken columns and tall grass provide cover around the perimeter.

TEACH	The mosaic is a 5m-diameter circle of white marble inlaid with gold Hebrew letters spelling 'Malkuth' (■■■■■■■■■■). It is placed in the exact center of the Open Fields, directly in the path between the player's entry point and the exit to the Gazebo Ruins. Stepping on it triggers a brief golden glow underfoot and a soft chime. A UI prompt appears: 'The ground remembers.' Farsa drops by 10%. The player learns: the ENVIRONMENT is not neutral. The world itself is a judge.
TEST	During the combat with angels in the Open Fields, the player must maneuver AROUND the mosaic while fighting. The angels, being celestial, can walk on it freely — they even use it as a rally point (they glow brighter when standing on it). The player learns spatial awareness: the battlefield has 'no-go zones' that are safe for enemies but dangerous for the player. If the player accidentally steps on the mosaic during combat (easy to do while dodging), Farsa drops and angels become more aggressive.
TWIST	The TWIST: after all angels are defeated, the mosaic CRACKS. A hidden compartment opens beneath it, revealing a Dark Relic fragment. But the compartment is surrounded by a secondary ring of smaller symbols. Touching ANY of these smaller symbols triggers a light burst (damage 15). The player must carefully navigate the ring to reach the relic. This teaches that rewards in Heaven are guarded by layers of sacred law.
MASTER	N/A

Audio/VFX: SFX: Stepping on mosaic = deep bell toll (like a church bell at midnight). Stepping on ring stones = sharp crystalline chime + light burst sound. VFX: Mosaic glows gold when stepped on. Ring stones glow white for 0.5s before bursting. Relic compartment emits purple (Shadow Purple) light when opened.

7.3 THE CELESTIAL SNARE

Beat:	Beat 5: Celestial Snare	Type:	Pattern-Recognition / Rhythm Trap	Farsa:	No Farsa interaction — automated celestial defense
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Justification:	The bridge between the Gazebo Ruins and the Sanctuary is not a path — it is a TRIAL. In biblical tradition, crossing into sacred space requires purification. The Celestial Snare is the Kingdom's automated defense system: rays of divine light that strike anyone who crosses without permission. It exists because Malkuth is a BORDER. Every kingdom has walls. This is Malkuth's wall — not stone, but light. The trap is not cruel; it is LAW. It does not hate Malakh; it simply does not recognize him.
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Layout: Long stone bridge (80m x 10m) over a reflecting pool. No cover. Lined with upward-flowing fountain cylinders (every 8m). At the far end: Sanctuary beacon (purple point light, visible from 200m). Kill Z volume under bridge.

TEACH	The bridge is 80m long and 10m wide. Every 3 seconds, a ray of light strikes a random point ahead of the player, leaving a glowing scar. Before each strike, the ground brightens for 1.5 seconds (gold → white) and a rising choir note plays. The player learns: watch the ground, listen to the audio, and move to safe zones. The first 20m of the bridge has single rays with 3-second gaps — easy to avoid.
TEST	Mid-bridge (20m–50m): rays begin to overlap. Two strike simultaneously from different angles. The safe zones shrink. The player must read TWO ground indicators at once and find the intersection of safe zones. Wrong step = 25% damage + 1-second Blind effect. The upward-flowing fountains along the bridge edges serve as visual anchors — when a fountain stops, a ray is about to strike nearby.
TWIST	Final third (50m–80m): rays strike rapidly (every 1.2 seconds) in alternating 'cross' and 'checkerboard' patterns. The TWIST: the pattern is NOT random. It follows the rhythm of the Gregorian chant playing in the background. Each ray strikes on a drum-like bass note. The player can PREDICT the pattern by listening to the music. Audio becomes a gameplay mechanic. Additionally, during the final 10 seconds, the upward-fountains STOP flowing — the safe zones between them disappear. The player must sprint the final 10m.
MASTER	N/A

Audio/VFX: Music: Gregorian chant becomes rhythmic and percussive. Each ray strike is timed to a bass drum note. SFX: Charge-up = rising choir note (1.5s). Impact = thunderclap + distant bell toll. VFX: Ground glows gold → white → strike. Scorched marble decal persists for 5 seconds after each strike.

7.4 GABRIEL'S MIRROR LABYRINTH

Beat:	Beat 9: Gabriel of the Gates	Type:	Labyrinth / Dialogue / Environmental Puzzle	Farsa:	Direct interaction — wrong answers reduce Farsa; mirror-gaze drains Farsa
Justification:	Gabriel is the guardian of Malkuth's gates. In Jewish tradition, Gabriel is the angel of revelation, judgment, and mercy. He does not fight with a sword; he fights with TRUTH. The mirror labyrinth exists because Gabriel's weapon is self-knowledge. He forces the intruder to confront their own reflection — and for Malakh, a demon wearing a saint's skin, that reflection is a lie. The puzzle exists because Malkuth's final defense is not physical force, but the unbearable weight of facing what you are.				

Layout: Circular arena, 40m diameter. Four pillars at cardinal points. 12 mirror panels (10x5m) with metallic=1, roughness=0 material. Reflecting pools at the four intercardinal points. Gabriel's throne of roots and stone at center. Upon Phase 3 trigger: destroy all mirror meshes, spawn cracked-floor decals, enable shadow-damage detection.

TEACH	Phase 1 — The Labyrinth (100%–70% HP): The arena fills with 12 large mirror panels (10m x 5m) arranged in a shifting maze. Gabriel speaks from beyond the mirrors: 'What brings you to the Kingdom?' Three answers appear on a dialogue wheel: (A) 'I seek redemption.' (B) 'I seek passage.' (C) Silence. The correct answer is (A) — it maintains Farsa. (B) is neutral. (C) makes Gabriel suspicious (-5% Farsa). Wrong answers activate traps: mirrors shoot light beams (line trace, 25 damage), floors become slippery (ice physics), or walls close in (mirror panels move toward center). The player learns: this is a test of PATIENCE and PERFORMANCE. Malakh must ACT like a penitent soul.
TEST	Phase 2 — The Doubt (70%–40% HP): Gabriel's voice shifts. 'Your shadow is too long. Your steps are too quiet.' The labyrinth shrinks — 4 random mirrors are destroyed, reducing paths. The remaining mirrors now show Malakh's TRUE reflection: shadow wings flickering behind his white robes. If the player looks at a mirror for more than 2 seconds, Farsa drains at 5% per second. Gabriel asks harder questions: 'When did you last pray?' 'Who do you serve?' The player must answer while avoiding mirror-gaze AND navigating the shrinking maze. A single Angel Messenger spawns as distraction, forcing the player to divide attention.
TWIST	Phase 3 — The Judgment (40%–0% HP): The TWIST. Gabriel speaks the truth: 'The Gates do not open for the penitent. They open for the patient. But you, Malakh... you are neither.' ALL mirrors SHATTER simultaneously. The arena becomes open combat. But the shattered mirrors leave cracked floor panels. Gabriel's shadow is cast on these cracks. Attacks aimed at his shadow deal 50% bonus damage. The player must now fight while reading the environment — the puzzle has become combat. Additionally, broken mirror shards on the floor reflect light randomly, creating blinding flashes (screen whiteout for 0.3s) if the player steps on them. The labyrinth that protected Gabriel now protects Malakh — if he is clever.
MASTER	The entire encounter is the MASTER puzzle. It integrates: navigation (labyrinth), performance (dialogue answers), resource management (Farsa), combat (angel add), environmental awareness (shadow-weakness, shard hazards), and audio cues (Gabriel's voice direction reveals his location behind mirrors).

Audio/VFX: Music: Phase 1 = solo Gregorian voice, questioning. Phase 2 = dissonant choir, arguing voices. Phase 3 = full orchestra + choir, Latin judgment lyrics. SFX: Mirror shatter = glass break + bass drop. Gabriel's voice = three voices (bass, tenor, soprano) in perfect unison. VFX: Mirror reflections show penitent Malakh (Farsa > 70%) or shadow-winged Malakh (Farsa < 70%). Shattered mirrors create persistent light-flash zones.

7.5 THE ALTAR'S CHOICE

Beat:	Beat 7: Sanctuary of Malkuth	Type:	Decision Puzzle / Risk-Reward	Farsa:	Direct Farsa interaction — resting reduces Farsa if overused; offering a Tear has no Farsa cost but reduces healing
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Justification: The Altar of Contemplation is not just a checkpoint — it is a MIRROR of the player's strategy. In Kabbalah, Malkuth is the sphere of ACTION. It is where divine will becomes physical reality. The Altar forces the player to choose: do you TRUST in your skill (offer the Tear for power) or do you PRESERVE your safety (keep the Tear for healing)? This puzzle exists because Malkuth is the realm of CONSEQUENCE. Every choice has a price. Even rest is not free.

Layout: The Altar is a 2m x 1m rectangular stone slab with gold emissive runes. It sits on a raised dais (0.5m) before the Angel Terrestrial statue. Four paths lead from the Sanctuary; three are blocked by purple celestial energy barriers. The north path is open.

TEACH	Player approaches the Altar. A UI prompt appears: 'Kneel in contemplation?' If yes, the camera shifts to a cinematic view of the Sanctuary. HP restores to 100. Tears of Repentance refill to 3. A checkpoint is set. The player learns: this is a SAFE ZONE. No enemies. No traps. But a second prompt appears after the first rest: 'Offer a Tear of Repentance for divine strength?' The player learns there is a CHOICE.
TEST	If the player offers a Tear: +20% damage buff for 3 minutes, but loses one healing charge permanently until next Altar. The player must weigh: do I need the damage for the upcoming boss (Gabriel), or do I need the healing for survival? If the player rests at the Altar MORE than once, Farsa drops by 3% per extra rest. The angels notice someone who is 'too careful.' The player learns: even safety can be suspicious in Heaven.
TWIST	The TWIST: if the player has collected ALL Dark Relics in Malkuth (3 total), a hidden third option appears at the Altar: 'Recite the Forbidden Name.' This is a SECRET choice. It does NOT appear in the UI unless conditions are met. Choosing it: +50% Corruptio, +30% damage, but Farsa drops to 0 instantly. The Sanctuary's peaceful music shifts to a dissonant drone. The Angel Terrestrial statue's eyes turn red. This teaches the player that SECRETS exist in Dark Angels, and they always come with a terrible price.
MASTER	N/A — This is a meta-puzzle. Its mastery is realized across the entire game, as the player learns to manage risk/reward at every Altar.

Audio/VFX: SFX: Altar interaction = distant choir chord resolving to major. Offering a Tear = single bell toll + warm wind gust. Secret option = reversed chant + sub-bass rumble. VFX: Altar glows gold during rest. Glows purple if secret option is selected.

7.6 Puzzle & Trap Integration Matrix

The following matrix shows how each puzzle/trampa connects to the level's core systems. No puzzle exists in isolation.

The Geometric Path	1	Neutral	No	Chime cues	Tree of Life geometry
Sacred Ground Symbols	3	-10% per step	Yes — during combat	Bell toll	Sanctified territory
Celestial Snare	5	No	No	Rhythm-based prediction	Border defense / purification
Gabriel's Mirror Labyrinth	9	-5% per wrong answer; -5%/s mirror-gaze	Yes — Phase 3	Voice direction + music phase	Judgment via self-knowledge
The Altar's Choice	7	-3% per extra rest; 0% on secret	No	Choir resolution	Action and consequence

8. ANNOTATED MAP — SPATIAL FLOW

The following describes the spatial layout of Malkuth from start to finish. The level is a linear ascent with optional branching for collectibles. The path mirrors the emotional arc: wonder → tension → conflict → triumph → transcendence. All visual descriptions align with GDD v2.0.

A. THE GEOMETRIC GARDEN (0:00–2:00)

Entry zone. Flat, wide, perfect grass. Hedges trimmed into sacred Hebrew symbols and geometric patterns. Upward-flowing fountains create melodic reversed-water sounds. Waterfall to the west (hidden Corruptio Shard). Forest edge to the north. The Estatua del Ángel Terrestrial stands at the far end, feet rooted in earth, wings touching sky. Pale gold sky. No sun. No shadow movement. Birds repeat the same three-note call mechanically. Flowers move in unison. PUZZLE: The Geometric Path — three hedge-rows, only the center (Tree of Life) is the true path.

B. THE HEDGE PATH (2:00–3:30)

Narrow path between geometric hedges. Two stone benches and a fallen column as cover. Angels patrol here. Thorn-barrier behind player prevents retreat. Lighting dims as hedges thicken, but the pale gold sky remains visible above.

C. THE CLEARING (3:30–5:00)

Open circular arena surrounded by hedges. Three elevation levels. Tall grass moves in unison. Broken columns for cover. Sacred symbol mosaic at center (stepping on it reduces Farsa). Spawn points: east, west, north obelisk. A stream runs through center — shallow, slows movement, water flows upward into the next basin. PUZZLE: Sacred Ground Symbols — the mosaic and its 12 surrounding ring stones.

D. THE GAZEBO RUINS (5:00–7:00)

Cliff edge overlooking the reflecting pool. Four pillars, broken dome. Polished marble floor acts as mirror. Archangel stands center. After combat, path continues down to the bridge. Lighting: dramatic, pale gold reflecting off water.

E. THE BRIDGE OF ASCENDING WATER (7:00–8:30)

Long stone bridge over the reflecting pool. No cover. Lined with upward-flowing fountains that periodically stop, revealing safe zones. Rays strike from above. At far end, the Sanctuary is visible as a beacon. Lake below is deep — falling is instant death. The sky above is 'wrong' — too still, too perfect. TRAP: Celestial Snare — pattern-based light rays.

F. THE SANCTUARY (10:30–12:00)

Natural cathedral: massive trees whose branches intertwine into a vaulted ceiling. Shafts of pale gold light pierce through. Central dais with the Angel Terrestrial statue. Altar of Contemplation before the statue. Four paths, three blocked by celestial energy. Safe zone. Warm light. The only sound is wind through the tree-cathedral (pipe-organ effect) and distant chant. PUZZLE: The Altar's Choice — rest, buff, or secret forbidden option.

G. THE AMPHITHEATER (12:00–14:00)

Natural stone tiers. Circular stage of polished marble. No cover. Sky darkens progressively from pale gold to storm-grey. The mountain rises behind the stage — the path to the Throne. Empty seats suggest this was once a place of celestial gathering.

H. THE THRONE OF MALKUTH (14:00–16:30)

Mountain peak platform. Circular arena, 40m diameter. Four pillars. Swirling vortex sky of brown and gold. Mirror labyrinth: polished marble walls, reflecting pools, suspended glass panels. Gabriel's throne of roots and stone at center. Upon victory, the platform cracks and a stairway of light ascends from the center. PUZZLE: Gabriel's Mirror Labyrinth — dialogue, traps, and shattered-arena combat.

I. THE ASCENSION STAIR (16:30–18:00)

Translucent stairway into the Yesod portal (swirling purple). The entire level is visible below. Pure purple light ahead. No interaction. Purely cinematic and emotional. Malakh's wings now show black tips — first visible corruption.

9. RETUNE LOG

This section is filled after playtests. Each entry tracks an observed problem, the hypothesis for why it occurred, the change made, and the result after re-testing. The goal is to let observed player behavior overrule designer assumptions.

Date	Build	Finding	Hypothesis	Change	Result

9.1 Known Risks for Playtest

- **Farsa clarity:** Players may not understand WHY angels suddenly attack when Farsa drops. Need clear visual/audio feedback (angels tilt heads, whisper, light turns red).
- **Geometric Path readability:** Players may not notice the hedge symbols are a puzzle. Need stronger visual contrast between the correct path (blooming flowers) and wrong paths (thorn growth).
- **Gabriel's labyrinth pacing:** The mirror-labyrinth boss may frustrate action-oriented players. Consider a 'skip' option after 3 failed attempts that converts Phase 1-2 into a simplified combat sequence (with Farsa penalty).
- **Trap readability:** Celestial Snare's audio-cue dependency may fail for hearing-impaired players. Ensure visual cues (ground glow) are sufficient without sound.
- **VR/Difficulty skew:** As Valve observed in Half-Life: Alyx, encounters that take 10–20s in flat-screen can take 1–2 min in VR. If Dark Angels ports to VR, all durations must be re-tested.
- **Sanctuary pacing:** The rest beat (10:30–12:00) might feel too long. Consider optional training dummies for engaged players.

10. APPENDIX

10.1 Audio Reference

Ambient: Gregorian chant base with reversed audio layers. Wind through trees (but no leaf rustle — unnatural). Upward-flowing fountains (reversed water sounds, melodic). Mechanical bird calls (three-note repeat). Distant harp. No reverb — sound is too dry for outdoors, signaling this is a 'room' disguised as a world.

Combat: Layered choir drones. Bass percussion (timpani, deep drums). Angelic war-cries (non-human, multi-layered, no face = no mouth sounds). Sword clashes (light-based, not metal). Shield shatter (stained glass). Trumpet stun (pure tone, no breath).

Boss (Gabriel): Three-movement suite. Phase 1: slow, questioning solo voice. Phase 2: accelerating dissonance, arguing voices. Phase 3: full dissonant choir+orchestra, Latin lyrics about judgment. Gabriel's voice: three voices (bass, tenor, soprano) in perfect unison.

Transition: Single sustained note resolving to major chord. Wind, distant bells, root-growth SFX (foreshadowing Yesod).

10.2 Visual Reference

Color Palette: Garden Green (#7CB342), Pale Gold (#D4AF37), Pure White (#FFFFFF), Cream Stone (#F5F5DC), Deep Brown (#5D4037), Shadow Purple (#4A148C).

Lighting: Constant late-afternoon pale gold. No visible sun. No moving shadows. Dramatic rim-lighting on angels. Ray traps use overexposed white-gold. Boss arena underlit from below (roots glow), overlit from above (vortex).

Key VFX: Angel death (feather dissolution into light). Dark Strike (shadow tendrils). Judgment Beam (scorched marble). Corruptio (purple-black particles). Portal (fractal purple light). Mirror reflections (show Malakh as penitent when Farsa high, shadow-winged when low).

10.3 Narrative Beats

0:00: Malakh awakens in the Geometric Garden. No memory of entry. Only the knowledge that he must ascend.

2:00: First angelic contact. The paradise is not empty. It is watched. The Farsa meter appears.

5:00: First elite kill. Malakh's darkness is stronger than their light. The first crack in the Masquerade.

7:00: The Bridge. A trial by faith — or by reflex. The upward water defies nature.

10:30: The Sanctuary. A moment of doubt. Does he belong here? The Altar offers false comfort.

14:00: Gabriel of the Gates. The first true gatekeeper. A test of patience in a world of mirrors.

16:30: Ascension. Malkuth is behind him. Yesod — the Foundation — awaits. His wings show black tips. The lie is already cracking.

11. PROMPT DE IA PARA UNREAL MCP — POC MALKUTH

Esta sección proporciona un prompt estructurado y listo para copiar y pegar en el Model Context Protocol (MCP) de Unreal Engine 5 para generar un Proof of Concept (POC) del nivel Malkuth. El prompt está diseñado para ser interpretado por un agente de IA conectado a Unreal Engine a través de MCP, capaz de generar blueprints, assets, lighting, y blockouts.

11.1 ¿Qué es el Unreal MCP?

El Model Context Protocol (MCP) de Unreal Engine permite que agentes de IA interactúen directamente con el editor. A través de prompts estructurados, la IA puede: crear niveles, colocar actores, generar blueprints, ajustar lighting, crear materiales, y prototipar mecánicas sin intervención manual del usuario. Este prompt está optimizado para Unreal Engine 5.4+ con plugins MCP habilitados.

11.2 Prompt Maestro — Copiar y Pegar

Instrucciones: Copia el siguiente bloque de texto y pégalo en tu cliente MCP de Unreal Engine. Asegúrate de tener un proyecto vacío de UE5 con Starter Content deshabilitado (para evitar contaminación visual).

PROMPT:

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ROLE: Unreal Engine 5 Level Designer & Prototyper
TASK: Generate a playable Proof of Concept (POC) for "Malkuth: The Kingdom" – Level 10 of Dark Angels.
ENGINE: Unreal Engine 5.4+
OUTPUT: A single playable map (.umap) with functional blueprints, basic lighting, placeholder meshes, and working mechanics.
TIME ESTIMATE: 18-minute level experience, compressed to a 5-minute POC loop.
---
```

1. PROJECT SETUP

- Create a new Level named "L_Malkuth_POC".
- Set Default Game Mode to a Third-Person Character with the following stats:
 - * Walk Speed: 400 | Sprint Speed: 600
 - * Jump Height: 400 | Air Control: 0.4
 - * Max Stamina: 100 (drains 10/s on sprint, 15/s on dodge, 20/s on heavy attack)
 - * Stamina Regen: 15/s after 1.5s delay
- Create a Player State struct with: HP (100), Corruptio (0-100), Farsa (0-100, default 100).

2. VISUAL DIRECTION – MALKUTH

Implement the following environment art pass using primitive shapes and basic materials:

Color Palette (Materials)

- Garden_Green: #7CB342 (grass, hedges)
- Pale_Gold: #D4AF37 (sky gradient, light shafts, trim)
- Pure_White: #FFFFFF (marble, angel robes, clouds)
- Cream_Stone: #F5F5DC (columns, walls, bridge)
- Deep_Brown: #5D4037 (earth, tree bark, statue base)
- Shadow_Purple: #4A148C (portal, corruption particles)

Environment Zones (Blockout)

A. GEOMETRIC GARDEN (0:00-2:00)

- Flat plane 200x200m with green material.
- Place 12 cube hedges (scaled 4x1x3) arranged in geometric patterns (Star of David, Tree of Life silhouette).
- 3 upward-flowing fountains: Cylinders with Niagara particle systems where water flows UPWARD (velocity Z = +200).
- 1 Statue_Angel_Terrestrial: A scaled capsule (body) + 2 rotated planes (wings) on a brown cube pedestal. Place at north end.

- Sky: ExponentialHeightFog with Pale_Gold tint. DirectionalLight at 15° angle, warm temperature (3500K), intensity 3.0.
- Ambient audio: Looping Gregorian chant (reversed layer at -20dB). Mechanical bird SFX (3-note repeat every 8s).

B. HEDGE PATH (2:00-3:30)

- Narrow corridor (8m wide) between two rows of hedges (cube walls, 3m tall).
- 2 stone benches (scaled cubes) and 1 fallen column (rotated cylinder) as cover.
- Invisible collision box at south end (thorn barrier) – blocks player retreat with a "divine barrier" VFX (sparkle on touch).

C. THE CLEARING (3:30-5:00)

- Circular arena 40m diameter. Center: sacred symbol mosaic (decals or flat cylinder with white material).
- 3 elevation levels: East/West ridges (raised planes +2m), North obelisk (tall cylinder +4m).
- Upward-flowing stream: Narrow plane with upward Niagara particles crossing the arena.
- Tall grass: Scaled planes with translucent green material, placed densely.

D. GAZEBO RUINS (5:00-7:00)

- Cliff edge: Raised terrain (landscape sculpt or large cube) overlooking a lower plane (reflecting pool).
- 4 pillars (cylinders 5m tall), broken dome (half-sphere, rotated 90°).
- Polished floor: Material with metallic=0.8, roughness=0.1 (mirror-like).
- Place Archangel_Boss placeholder (scaled capsule 2.5m, white emissive material) at center, facing away.

E. THE BRIDGE (7:00-8:30)

- Long plane 10m wide x 80m long over a lower plane (water).
- Line both sides with upward-fountain cylinders.
- No cover. At far end: Sanctuary beacon (point light, purple #4A148C, intensity 5000, visible from 200m).
- Kill Z volume under bridge (fall = respawn at bridge start).

F. SANCTUARY (10:30-12:00)

- Grove cathedral: 8 massive tree trunks (brown cylinders 15m tall) arranged in a circle.
- Branches: Crossed planes forming a vault ceiling.
- Central dais: Raised platform (1m) with Statue_Angel_Terrestrial.
- Altar of Contemplation: Small cube with gold emissive material. Interact (E key) to:
 - * Restore HP to 100
 - * Refill Tears of Repentance to 3
 - * Set checkpoint (respawn point)
 - * Reduce Farsa by 3% if used more than once
- Block 3 of 4 exit paths with celestial energy barriers (purple emissive planes with collision).

G. AMPHITHEATER (12:00-14:00)

- Tiered seating: 5 rows of stepped cubes on 3 sides.
- Circular stage: Polished marble plane 20m diameter.
- Sky darkening: Trigger a PostProcessVolume that desaturates gold and increases contrast when player enters.

H. THRONE OF MALKUTH (14:00-16:30)

- Mountain peak: Highest point in level. Circular arena 40m diameter.
- 4 pillars at cardinal points.
- Mirror labyrinth: Place 12 large planes (10x5m) with mirror material (metallic=1, roughness=0). Arrange in maze pattern.
- Throne: Scaled cube with root-like protrusions (scaled thin cubes) at center.
- Boss trigger: Box collision that starts Gabriel encounter on overlap.

I. ASCENSION STAIR (16:30-18:00)

- Translucent staircase (glass material, opacity 0.3) ascending 30m.
- At top: Portal (rotating torus with purple emissive material, Niagara swirl particles).
- Level end: Box collision at portal → Load Level "L_Yesod_POC" (or display "TO BE CONTINUED" UI).

3. ENEMY BLUEPRINTS

BP_Angel_Messenger

- Mesh: Capsule (1.8m) + 2 rotated planes (wings, white translucent).
- Material: White emissive for face (no face geometry – just a glowing sphere).
- AI Behavior Tree:
 - * Patrol: Move between 3 target points (loop).

- * Observation: If player within 10m and Farsa > 70%, play "head tilt" animation (rotate mesh 15°) and resume patrol.
- * Hostile Trigger: If player attacks, breaks a sacred object (hedge, fountain), OR Farsa < 40% → switch to Attack state.
- * Attack: Move to player. Melee: Sphere trace every 1.2s, damage 15. Trumpet Stun: Every 8s, play sound + screen shake + stun player for 0.8s.
- * Reinforcement: If HP < 50%, spawn 1 additional BP_Angel_Messenger at nearest spawn point (max 1 call).
- * Desperation: If any allied Archangel is below 50% HP, self-destruct on death (sphere overlap, damage 30, radius 3m, white particle explosion).
- * Death: Destroy mesh, spawn Niagara feather-dissolve effect, drop Corruptio_Shard (+15 Corruptio).
- Stats: HP 60 | Speed 250 | Damage 15

BP_Archangel

- Mesh: Capsule (2.5m) + 6 rotated planes (3 wing pairs, white emissive).
- Material: Armor = solid white emissive. Sword = white fire (emissive cylinder + Niagara flame trail).
- AI Behavior Tree:
 - * Phase 1 (100-70%): Walk toward player. Heavy swing: Sphere trace every 2.5s, damage 35, slow wind-up (telegraphed with sword glow).
 - * Shield: At 70% HP, spawn BP_LightShield (sphere collision, blocks all damage). Shield breaks after 3 Dark Strikes or 5s.
 - * Phase 2 (70-40%): Same as Phase 1 + Judgment Beam: Every 12s, spawn vertical cylinder (height 20m, radius 1m) at player location. Follows player for 3s. Damage 20/tick. Leave scorched decal.
 - * Phase 3 (40-0%): Move speed +20%. Summon 1 BP_Angel_Messenger every 20s.
- Stats: HP 400 | Speed 150 | Damage 35

BP_Gabriel (Boss)

- Mesh: Same as Archangel but with root-throne base.
- Phase 1 – Labyrinth (100-70%):
 - * Player must reach Gabriel through mirror maze. Mirrors = collision planes that reflect projectiles (if any).
 - * Gabriel asks questions via UI widget (dialogue wheel). 3 questions, 3 answers each.
 - * Correct answer (humble/penitent): Gabriel says "Proceed." Mirror shifts (open path).
 - * Wrong answer (defiant): Activate trap – mirror shoots light beam (line trace, damage 25) OR floor becomes slippery (ice physics material) OR walls close in (move mirror planes toward center).
 - * Farsa check: If Farsa < 50%, Gabriel says "Your shadow is too long" – all traps activate simultaneously.
- Phase 2 – Doubt (70-40%):
 - * Labyrinth shrinks: Destroy 4 random mirror planes.
 - * Mirrors now show player reflection with black wings (swap player mesh material to shadow-winged version when near mirrors).
 - * Gazing at mirror for >2s reduces Farsa by 5%/sec.
 - * Summon 1 BP_Angel_Messenger as distraction.
- Phase 3 – Judgment (40-0%):
 - * Destroy ALL mirror planes. Arena becomes open combat.
 - * Gabriel fights as full Archangel BUT takes 50% bonus damage from attacks aimed at his shadow (projected on floor – use decal or second mesh below floor).
 - * Light Shield regenerates every 15s.
 - * At 10% HP, Gabriel kneels, plays crystallization animation (material transitions to salt/grey), then crumbles (Niagara dust burst).
- Stats: HP 800 | Speed 180 | Damage 40

4. PLAYER MECHANICS (Blueprints)

BP_PlayerCharacter

- Light Attack: Montage + sphere trace (damage 20, stamina 10).
- Heavy Attack: Montage (0.8s wind-up) + sphere trace (damage 45, stamina 25, breaks posture).
- Charged Attack: Hold button >1.5s. Release for massive sphere trace (damage 80, stamina 40, posture break).
- Dodge Roll: Montage + launch character (directional). Invincibility frames 0.3s. Stamina 15.
- Block: Hold button. Reduces incoming damage by 60%. Stamina drain 10/s. Perfect parry window: first 0.2s of block. If parry succeeds, enemy posture broken (stun 2s).
- Dark Strike (Umbral Lunge): Press Ability button. If Corruptio >= 30, launch forward 8m, sphere trace (damage 60, ignores Light Shield). Cost: 30 Corruptio. Cooldown 8s.
- Wings (Glide): Unlocked after Gabriel defeat. Hold Jump in air to reduce gravity to 0.3x. Aerial Dodge: Press Dodge in air (launch + iframes).

- Farsa System:
 - * Default: 100%. Decay sources: Use Dark Ability (-5%), break sacred object (-10%), kill angel brutally (execution, -5%), take light damage (-5%), rest at altar too many times (-3%).
 - * Gain sources: Evade enemy without killing (+1% per enemy), pray at altar (+5%), wear penitent armor (+20%, not in POC).
 - * Consequences:
 - 70-100%: Angels ignore player unless attacked.
 - 40-69%: Angels observe player. Some become aggressive.
 - 20-39%: Angels attack on sight. Inspectors spawn.
 - 0-19%: All enemies hostile. Bosses gain extra attacks.
 - Death: Spawn "Mancha de Sombra" (black decal) at death location. Drop all Essences. On respawn, max Farsa reduced by 10% (permanent for this life, min 50%).

5. TRAP SYSTEM

BP_CelestialRay

- Trigger: Box collision on bridge. Every 3s, spawn decal on ground (brightening spot, 1.5s warning).
- After warning: Spawn vertical cylinder (height 20m, radius 0.8m) at decal location. Damage 25/tick. Duration 1s.
- Pattern: Single → Double overlap → Rapid sequence (1.2s interval) in cross/checkerboard.
- Audio cue: Rising choir note (1.5s) before each strike.

6. UI WIDGETS

- HUD: HP bar (bottom left), Stamina bar (bottom center), Corruptio bar (bottom right), Farsa meter (top center, color-coded: green/yellow/orange/red).
- Boss Bar: Appears during Gabriel fight. Shows Gabriel's HP and current phase text ("The Labyrinth", "The Doubt", "The Judgment").
- Dialogue Wheel: Appears during Gabriel Phase 1. 3 radial options. Timer 8s per question. Auto-select "Silence" (neutral, no Farsa change) if timer expires.

7. LIGHTING & POST-PROCESS

- Global: DirectionalLight (pale gold, 3500K, intensity 3.0, angle 15°). Skylight (pale gold, intensity 1.0).
- Malkuth mood: ExponentialHeightFog (gold tint, density 0.02). No dynamic time of day – shadows are static.
- Sanctuary: Point lights in trees (warm white, intensity 200, attenuation 10m). Emissive particles (pollen).
- Amphitheater: PostProcessVolume on enter → desaturate -0.3, increase contrast +0.2, darken sky.
- Boss Arena: Volumetric fog (brown-gold). Point lights under floor (root glow, orange). Spotlights from above (vortex effect, rotating).
- Portal: Emissive purple material + Niagara swirl. Bloom intensity 5.0.

8. AUDIO IMPLEMENTATION

- Ambient: 2D looping sound cue – Gregorian chant base + reversed layer (-20dB).
- Combat music: 2D sound cue triggered on enemy aggro. Layered intensity (add percussion when HP < 50%).
- Gabriel music: 3-phase sound cue. Phase 1: solo voice. Phase 2: dissonant choir. Phase 3: full orchestra.
- SFX: Angel death (feather rustle + light chime). Shield break (glass shatter). Judgment Beam (thunderclap + bell). Portal (wind + rising choir).

9. ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- [] Player can walk from Garden to Portal in 5 minutes (compressed POC timing).
- [] All 3 enemy types spawn and behave according to AI specs.
- [] Farsa system visibly affects angel behavior (test by setting Farsa to 0 in details panel).
- [] Gabriel boss fight progresses through all 3 phases.
- [] Celestial Snare traps fire in pattern and damage player.
- [] Altar of Contemplation restores HP and sets checkpoint.
- [] Visual palette matches Garden_Green / Pale_Gold / Pure_White / Shadow_Purple.
- [] No Starter Content meshes visible (use primitives only).
- [] Frame rate stable at 60fps in editor viewport (RTX 3070 equivalent).

10. DELIVERABLES

- L_Malkuth_POC.umap
- BP_PlayerCharacter
- BP_Angel_Messenger, BP_Archangel, BP_Gabriel
- BP_CelestialRay, BP_LightShield
- 10 Materials (Garden_Green, Pale_Gold, Pure_White, Cream_Stone, Deep_Brown, Shadow_Purple, Mirror, Water_Upward, Salt_Crystal, Angel_Emissive)
- 5 Niagara Systems (Upward_Fountain, Feather_Dissolve, Corruptio_Particles, Portal_Swirl, Judgment_Beam)

- 5 UI Widgets (HUD, BossBar, DialogueWheel, DeathScreen, PauseMenu)
- 1 Data Table (DT_FarsaEvents – rows for all Farsa decay/gain sources)

11.3 Especificaciones Técnicas del POC

Engine	Unreal Engine 5.4+ with MCP plugin enabled
Renderer	Lumen + Nanite enabled (for lighting and high-poly primitives)
Target FPS	60fps in Editor Viewport (RTX 3070 equivalent)
Map Size	Single streaming level, 500x500m playable area
Mesh Strategy	100% primitive shapes (cubes, cylinders, planes, spheres). No external assets.
Materials	Basic UE5 materials with color/roughness/metallic/emissive only. No textures.
Blueprints	All mechanics via Blueprint (no C++ required for POC).
Niagara	Upward fountains, feather dissolve, corruptio particles, portal swirl, judgment beam.
AI	Behavior Trees + Blackboard for Angel Messenger, Archangel, Gabriel.
UI	UMG Widgets: HUD, Boss Bar, Dialogue Wheel, Death Screen.
Audio	2D/3D Sound Cues. Placeholder royalty-free Gregorian chant + synthesized SFX.

11.4 Criterios de Aceptación del POC

- El jugador puede recorrer el nivel completo (Garden → Hedge Path → Clearing → Gazebo → Bridge → Sanctuary → Amphitheater → Throne → Ascension) en 5 minutos.
- Los 3 tipos de enemigos (Angel Messenger, Archangel, Gabriel) spawnear y comportarse según las especificaciones de AI.
- El sistema de Farsa afecta visiblemente el comportamiento de los ángeles (testear con Farsa=0 en el Details Panel).
- El boss Gabriel progresa por sus 3 fases (Laberinto → Duda → Juicio) sin soft-locks.
- Las trampas Celestial Snare disparan en patrón y dañan al jugador.
- El Altar de Contemplación restaura HP y establece checkpoint.
- La paleta visual coincide con Garden_Green / Pale_Gold / Pure_White / Shadow_Purple.
- No hay meshes de Starter Content visibles (solo primitivas).
- Frame rate estable a 60fps en Editor Viewport.

11.5 Notas para el Diseñador Humano

El MCP no reemplaza el juicio artístico. Este prompt genera un blockout funcional — una prueba de concepto. Una vez validado el pacing, las mecánicas y el flujo, un artista y level designer humanos deben:

1. Reemplazar primitivas por assets finales (esculturas, arquitectura greco-hebrea, estatuas del Ángel Terrestrial).
2. Refinar materiales: añadir normal maps, subsurface scattering en mármol, translucency en alas de ángeles.
3. Iterar lighting: Lumen reflections en espejos, volumetric god-rays en el Santuario, shadow baking para el cielo estático.
4. Polish de audio: grabar coro gregoriano original, diseñar SFX custom (campanas, alas, trompetas).
5. Balanceo numérico: ajustar HP, daño, velocidad de stamina según datos de playtest (Retune Log, Sección 9).

Regla de oro: El POC prueba que el nivel *funciona*. El arte y el polish prueban que el nivel *resuena*.